AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

+27 76 757 5773
www.africansolidaritycivic.org

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Woolworths Trust × ASCO

Climate-Smart Community Food Gardens and Youth Livelihoods Pilot

Requested CSI investment: R75,000

Proposed implementation area: A rural or peri-urban South African community selected through needs assessment, with the Free State as a proposal option because Woolworths publicly references food-security work in Mangaung/Thaba Nchu, Kroonstad and Bultfontein; this is a proposed location, not an existing ASCO-Woolworths site.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Woolworths Trust** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Climate-Smart Community Food Gardens and Youth Livelihoods Pilot**. The proposed request is **R75,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Climate-Smart Community Food Gardens and Youth Livelihoods Pilot in A rural or peri-urban South African community selected through needs assessment, with the Free State as a proposal option because Woolworths publicly references food-security work in Mangaung/Thaba Nchu, Kroonstad and Bultfontein; this is a proposed location, not an existing ASCO-Woolworths site., benefiting Proposed beneficiaries: low-income and food-insecure households, young people and emerging smallholder/community farmers in the selected community, subject to baseline assessment and Woolworths/Trust approval. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Woolworths Trust's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R75,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Climate-Smart Community Food Gardens and Youth Livelihoods Pilot

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
A rural or peri-urban South African community selected through needs assessment, with the Free State as a proposal option because Woolworths publicly references food-security work in Mangaung/Thaba Nchu, Kroonstad and Bultfontein; this is a proposed location, not an existing ASCO-Woolworths site.

Target beneficiaries
Proposed beneficiaries: low-income and food-insecure households, young people and emerging smallholder/community farmers in the selected community, subject to baseline assessment and Woolworths/Trust approval.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: establish or rehabilitate 3 community food gardens using water-wise, soil-health and climate-smart practices.
- Proposed: train at least 30 youth and community growers in sustainable production, nutrition, basic enterprise skills and environmental stewardship.
- Proposed: support at least 60 participating households with garden inputs, locally appropriate technical assistance and monitoring, subject to verified baseline need.
- Proposed: deliver a 12-month implementation and learning report covering participation, harvest/food-access indicators, water-use practices, survival rates and continuation plan.
- Proposed: create a scale-up and co-funding plan suitable for a possible multi-year intervention; targets require confirmation during scoping.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the

specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Woolworths Trust?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

Verified company context

- The Woolworths Trust was established in 2003, is managed by a Board of Trustees, and oversees Woolworths social-development activity in South Africa; it reports to the WHL Board Social and Ethics Committee.
- The Trust's stated focus includes food security, reducing child vulnerability and education; its official examples include school and community food gardens, education support and surplus-food donations to charities.
- Woolworths Holdings describes social-development priorities as education, food security and disaster relief for Woolworths, with an emphasis on empowerment, inclusive participation and long-term sustainable social development.
- The Trust's CSI policy prefers multi-year interventions over once-off projects and considers relevance, scalability and potential for future expansion; flagship projects may receive three- to five-year commitments.
- Official Woolworths material links food security with reducing food waste and describes sustainable/climate-smart agriculture, community learning farms, smallholder farmer networks and environmental protection as relevant programme examples.
- The official 2024 Good Business Journey report identifies climate change, water, biodiversity, and packaging/waste/circular economy as material environmental issues, alongside social development focused on education, food security, community resilience and involvement.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R45,100	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R6,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R4,500	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R6,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R5,200	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R5,200	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R3,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R75,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R75,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Use Woolworths Holdings' official general-enquiries route: +27 21 407 9111 (https://www.woolworthsholdings.co.za/contacts/general/) and request referral to the Woolworths Trust/CSI decision-maker. No public Trust application route was found in the reviewed official sources. ASCO's stated contact is +27 76 757 5773 and https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- No dedicated public Woolworths Trust application form, open call, eligibility checklist or confirmed grant budget was located in the reviewed official sources; approach the Trust/WHL for current process and fit before treating the R75,000 ask as eligible.
- Woolworths prefers sustainable, scalable and generally multi-year interventions; a R75,000 single-year project may need to be presented as a pilot with a credible continuation plan.
- The official pages describe existing programmes and partners but do not confirm that Woolworths will fund a new ASCO proposal, any particular geography, or any proposed target numbers.
- Do not claim Section 18A approval, completed ASCO results, existing partnerships, or Woolworths funding/commitment.
- Final eligibility may require governance, budgets, monitoring evidence, safeguarding, beneficiary verification, tax/PBO documentation and other due-diligence materials; these requirements were not specified in the reviewed pages.
- Avoid positioning the project as an individual grant, scholarship, political/religious/cultural/sport initiative, or pure charity request because these categories are expressly excluded in principle.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Woolworths Trust** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.woolworths.co.za/content/article/good-business-journey/good-business-journey/the-woolworths-trust/_/A-cmp205955
2. https://www.woolworthsholdings.co.za/social-development/
3. https://www.woolworths.co.za/content/look/web-content/gbj-social-development-chapter/_/A-cmp213977
4. https://www.woolworthsholdings.co.za/wp-content/uploads/2024/09/2024-Good-Business-Journey-Report.pdf
5. https://www.woolworthsholdings.co.za/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/Integrated_Annual_Report_2024.pdf
6. https://www.woolworthsholdings.co.za/contacts/general/

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.